

EPPP COGNITIVE DEVELOPMENT QUIZ

25 Application-Based Questions | Piaget, Vygotsky, Information Processing

INSTRUCTIONS:

- Select the best answer for each question
- Write your answer (A, B, C, or D) in the space provided
- Answer key and explanations on last page

1. A 4-year-old child believes that the moon follows her when she walks at night. According to Piaget, this illustrates:

- A. Object permanence
- B. Egocentrism
- C. Conservation
- D. Abstract reasoning

Your Answer: _____

2. True/False: According to Piaget, assimilation involves modifying existing cognitive schemas to incorporate new knowledge.

- A. True
- B. False

Your Answer: _____

3. A child who can correctly arrange sticks from shortest to longest but struggles with class inclusion problems is most likely in which stage?

- A. Sensorimotor
- B. Preoperational
- C. Concrete Operational
- D. Formal Operational

Your Answer: _____

4. True/False: Object permanence develops suddenly at age 2 when children enter the preoperational stage.

A. True

B. False

Your Answer: _____

5. A 15-year-old is able to generate multiple hypotheses about why her friend didn't text back. This demonstrates:

A. Concrete operational thinking

B. Hypothetico-deductive reasoning

C. Egocentrism

D. Transductive reasoning

Your Answer: _____

6. According to Piaget, the motivation for cognitive development comes from:

- A. External rewards from parents
- B. A drive toward cognitive equilibrium (equilibration)
- C. Social interaction with peers
- D. Biological maturation alone

Your Answer: _____

7. True/False: Horizontal decalage refers to the simultaneous acquisition of all abilities within a Piagetian stage.

- A. True
- B. False

Your Answer: _____

8. A child believes that breaking 4 cookies into 8 pieces means there are 'more cookies now.' This demonstrates lack of:

- A. Object permanence
- B. Conservation
- C. Symbolic function
- D. Mental operations

Your Answer: _____

9. A teacher models each step of a math problem, then gradually lets students work independently. This best exemplifies:

- A. Piagetian discovery learning
- B. Vygotskian scaffolding
- C. Information processing chunking
- D. Classical conditioning

Your Answer: _____

10. True/False: According to Vygotsky, all learning is first interpersonal (social) and then becomes intrapersonal (internalized).

A. True

B. False

Your Answer: _____

11. The Zone of Proximal Development refers to:

- A. The gap between current abilities and potential abilities with adult support
- B. The physical space where optimal learning occurs
- C. The age range for each Piagetian stage
- D. The difference between chronological and mental age

Your Answer: _____

12. A 5-year-old talks herself through tying her shoes: 'First cross the laces, then make a loop...'
According to Vygotsky, this is:

- A. Evidence of egocentrism
- B. Private speech for self-regulation
- C. Magical thinking
- D. Sensorimotor circular reaction

Your Answer: _____

13. True/False: Symbolic play has no cognitive benefit according to Vygotsky.

- A. True
- B. False

Your Answer: _____

14. Improvements in memory during childhood are BEST explained by information processing theory as:

- A. Qualitative shifts in thinking
- B. Increases in memory capacity, processing speed, and automaticity
- C. Social interaction and cultural tools
- D. Biological maturation of frontal lobes only

Your Answer: _____

15. True/False: Neo-Piagetian theories reject the concept of stages entirely.

- A. True

B. False

Your Answer: _____

16. Unlike Piagetians, information processing theorists view cognitive ability as:

- A. Globally consistent across domains
- B. Task-specific and domain-focused
- C. Determined solely by biological maturation
- D. Only measurable through clinical interviews

Your Answer: _____

17. Understanding that another person might have false beliefs typically develops around age:

- A. 2-3 years
- B. 4-5 years
- C. 6-7 years
- D. 8-10 years

Your Answer: _____

18. True/False: By age 6, children realize that people's actions are not always consistent with their true thoughts.

- A. True
- B. False

Your Answer: _____

19. A 2-year-old shows surprise when mother looks for a toy where the child knows it isn't. This suggests:

- A. Fully developed theory of mind
- B. Beginning to understand others have different perceptions
- C. Demonstrating egocentrism
- D. Showing object permanence

Your Answer: _____

20. By 3 months of age, infants demonstrate recognition memory for up to:

- A. 1 hour

B. 24 hours

C. 1 week

D. 1 month

Your Answer: _____

21. True/False: Infantile amnesia is primarily caused by lack of language abilities to encode events.

- A. True - only language
- B. False - multiple factors

Your Answer: _____

22. The 'reminiscence bump' refers to tendency to recall more events from:

- A. Early childhood (ages 2-5)
- B. Adolescence and young adulthood (ages 10-30)
- C. Middle adulthood (ages 40-50)
- D. Recent past

Your Answer: _____

23. True/False: Older adults show greater decline in explicit memory compared to implicit memory.

- A. True
- B. False

Your Answer: _____

24. The ability to recall past events (not just recognize) is apparent by:

- A. 3 months
- B. 6-12 months
- C. 18-24 months
- D. 3-4 years

Your Answer: _____

25. Which memory strategy do children typically acquire FIRST?

- A. Elaboration
- B. Organization
- C. Rehearsal
- D. Method of loci

Your Answer: _____

ANSWER KEY

Question	Correct Answer
1	B
2	B
3	C
4	B
5	B
6	B
7	B
8	B
9	B
10	A
11	A
12	B
13	B
14	B
15	B
16	B
17	B
18	A
19	B
20	B
21	B
22	B
23	A
24	B
25	C

EXPLANATIONS

Question 1: Egocentrism (Preoperational stage) - the inability to distinguish between one's own perspective and others'.

Question 2: FALSE - That describes ACCOMMODATION. Assimilation is incorporating new knowledge into EXISTING schemas.

Question 3: Concrete Operational (7-11 years) - can seriate but struggles with hierarchical classification.

Question 4: FALSE - Object permanence begins developing in substage 4 of the Sensorimotor stage (8-12 months).

Question 5: Hypothetico-deductive reasoning (Formal Operational stage) - systematically testing competing hypotheses.

Question 6: Equilibration - the drive to resolve disequilibrium through assimilation and accommodation.

Question 7: FALSE - Horizontal decalage describes the GRADUAL acquisition of abilities within a stage.

Question 8: Conservation - understanding that quantity remains the same despite changes in appearance.

Question 9: Scaffolding (Vygotsky) - providing instruction and support within ZPD, then gradually removing it.

Question 10: TRUE - Vygotsky emphasized learning occurs first through social interaction, then is internalized.

Question 11: ZPD is the discrepancy between what a child can do independently versus with scaffolding.

Question 12: Private speech - self-directed speech that helps children regulate and organize behavior.

Question 13: FALSE - Vygotsky believed symbolic play provides ZPD for practicing behaviors with less precision than reality.

Question 14: Information processing focuses on quantitative increases in capacity, speed, and automaticity.

Question 15: FALSE - Neo-Piagetian theories COMBINE Piagetian and information processing approaches, retaining stages.

Question 16: Information processing theorists focus on specific domains and task-specific skill use.

Question 17: 4-5 years - children understand others can have false beliefs and act on them (false-belief task).

Question 18: TRUE - Around age 6, children develop sophisticated theory of mind about behavior/internal state mismatch.

Question 19: Ages 2-3 - children begin understanding others have different mental states (perceptions, desires).

Question 20: 24 hours - habituation studies show 3-month-olds recognize stimuli up to 24 hours after exposure.

Question 21: FALSE - While language plays a role, infantile amnesia is also due to incomplete brain structure development.

Question 22: Ages 10-30 - adults recall more events from adolescence/young adulthood, possibly due to identity formation.

Question 23: TRUE - Research shows age has greater negative impact on explicit (conscious) than implicit (unconscious) memory.

Question 24: 6-12 months - imitation tasks show infants this age can recall sequences of events.

Question 25: Rehearsal - children begin with simple rehearsal, followed by organization, then elaboration.

